

040. Chapter 3 Verses 38-39

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.38

धूमेनाव्रियते वह्निर्यथादर्शो मलेन च ।
यथोल्बेनावृतो गर्भस्तथा तेनेदमावृतम् ॥ 38 ॥

dhūmenāvriyate vahniry
athādarśo malena ca |
yatholbenāvṛto garbhas
tathā tenedamāvṛtam ||

- ◆ **dhūmena** – by smoke; **āvriyate** – is covered; **vahniḥ** – fire; **yathā** – as;
- ◆ **ādarśaḥ** – mirror; **malena** – by dust/dirt; **ca** – and;
- ◆ **yathā** – as; **ulbena** – by the amnion (membrane); **āvṛtaḥ** – covered; **garbhaḥ** – embryo;
- ◆ **tathā** – so; **tenā** – by that (desire); **idam** – this (wisdom); **āvṛtam** – is covered.

As fire is enveloped by smoke, as a mirror by dust, as an embryo by the amnion, so this knowledge of the Self is enveloped by Kama and Krodha.

VERSE 3.39

आवृतं ज्ञानमेतेन ज्ञानिनो नित्यवैरिणा ।
कामरूपेण कौन्तेय दुष्पूरेणानलेन च ॥ 39 ॥

- ◆ āvṛtaṃ jñānametena
- ◆ jñānino nityavairiṇā |
- ◆ kāmarūpeṇa kaunteya
- ◆ duṣpūreṇānalena ca ||

āvṛtaṃ – covered; jñānam – knowledge; etena – by this;
jñāninaḥ – of the wise; nitya-vairiṇā – by the eternal enemy;
kāma-rūpeṇa – in the form of desire; kaunteya – O son of Kunti;
duṣpūreṇa – insatiable; analena – fire; ca – and.
cha—and

**O Arjuna! Knowledge of the Self is covered by this
everlasting foe of the wise in the form of desire, insatiable
like fire.**